

User Research: Users Arrive With Feeling, Not Facts

User research

SURVEY FINDINGS, N=59: 8 QUESTIONS ANSWERED

● Search behavior (Q6, Q8, Q9)

Q6 What do users type first?

A single broad keyword or a loose two-word combo, because that's all they can recall.

31% one broad keyword · 71% start vague

Q8 How quickly do users give up?

The system gets very few chances before users walk away.

73% quit in 2-3 tries · 17% skip search

Q9 Do users describe or guess?

They want to say more, but learned that detailed description doesn't work.

32% forced to guess single keywords

● Memory gap (Q4, Q5)

Q4 What do users clearly remember?

The life event, the rough era, the vibe of the place, who they were with. Emotional and contextual cues, not hard facts.

49% recall the life event or reason

44% recall the rough timeframe or era

Q5 What do users forget?

The exact date, the venue name, the album, the upload source. Precisely the metadata that search depends on.

47% forget the exact date, month or year

41% forget the venue · 32% the album

● Post-search frustration (Q12-14)

Q12 Are users overwhelmed by results?

Similar-looking photos flood the results. Volume without structure is the problem.

52% regularly feel overwhelmed

Q13 Does the system help narrow down?

Either not enough help or a complete dead end. Only 20% find it easy to refine.

79% say no · 25% wipe and start over

Q14 Where does frustration peak?

Equally split. The system fails at both extremes: no results and too many.

32% zero results · 32% 1,000 irrelevant

PATTERN

Users arrive with feeling, not facts.

Search returns volume, not direction.

Between the first result and the right photo, nothing exists to help them get there.

Fixing retrieval also converts free users who were on the fence about upgrading

~160M

free users affected

×

0.5%

upgrade lift (conservative)

×

\$36/yr

ARPU (annual)

=

~\$29M

new ARR

Intro

AI Discovery

Decomposition

User research

Segmentation

Problem

Solution

MVP

Metrics

Risks